

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called 'The Armlet of the Victory Banner's Peak'

Ārya-dhvajāgraKeyūra-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 612 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་རྒྱ་མཚན་གཅི་མེའོ་དཔུ་རྒྱ་ཅས་བ་བྱའ་གི་བྱུངས།

Toh 612 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-dhvajāgraKeyūra-nāma-dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Phags pa rgyal mtshan gyi rtse mo'i dpung rgyan ces bya ba'i gzungs, meaning "The Noble Dhāraṇī Called The Armlet of the Victory Banner's Peak." It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur and presents a protective incantation set within a narrative frame in which Śakra, lord of the gods, has been defeated in battle by the asura lord Vemacitrin and seeks refuge with the Buddha in the realm of the Thirty-Three Gods. The text unfolds as a discourse in which the Buddha responds to Śakra's appeal by imparting the dhāraṇī, conveying its power to protect and bring victory to those who invoke it. As a dhāraṇī sūtra, it combines the narrative conventions of a canonical discourse with the ritual function of a sacred formula intended for recitation and protection.

In the language of India: Ārya-dhvajāgraKeyūra-nāma-dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The noble dhāraṇī called "The Armlet of the Victory Banner's Peak."

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was residing in the realm of the Thirty-Three Gods, seated upon a flat stone like a white crystal slab. Now, Śakra, the lord of the gods (Indra, king of the gods), had been defeated and utterly routed by the asuras (demigods), and in his defeat he made his way in a shrunken and shriveled form to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, he prostrated with his head at the feet of the Blessed One and spoke these words to him:

"Blessed One, I have engaged the asuras in battle and have been defeated and completely routed by Vemacitrin, the lord of the asuras. The gods of the Thirty-Three as well have been defeated and completely routed. Blessed One, what are we to do about this?"

The Blessed One declared: "Lord of the gods, you should take up this dhāraṇī called 'The Armlet of the Victory Banner's Peak,' which cannot be overcome by others. I too, in a former life when I was a bodhisattva, received this from a Tathāgata whose banner of invincibility could not be overcome by others, and

having received it, I expounded it widely and correctly to others. From that time forward, I never once experienced fear, or dread, or the hair of my body standing on end, nor did I experience any harm to my body even for an instant."

The Blessed One was then asked: "What, Blessed One, is this dhāraṇī called 'The Armlet of the Victory Banner's Peak,' which cannot be overcome by others?"

The Blessed One declared: Tadyathā: oṃ jaya jaya, vijaya vijaya, jayavāhini, śaṃkari śaṃkari, prabhāṃkari — protect me and all sentient beings: sarvāśatrūṃ, jambhaya jambhaya, stambhaya stambhaya, mohaya mohaya, bhagavati, jayavāhini, matha matha, pramatha pramatha, grāsa grāsa, hāsa hāsa, hūṃ hūṃ, la hūṃ la hūṃ, lamodari, trinetra, caturbhaktre, caturdaṃṣṭre, caturbhujе, asimusalā, cakra, triśūla, vajrakavachadhāraṇi — protect me from all harm, protect me from all harm! Oṃ bhagavati, hana hana, daha daha, paca paca, matha matha, pramatha pramatha, dhuna dhuna, bidhuna bidhuna, hūṃ hūṃ, phaṭ phaṭ, bhañja bhañja, parasainyaṃ vidhvaṃsaya, sarvaśatrūn nāśaya, dhvajāgrakeyūre, triṭa triṭa triṭa, bhriṭa bhriṭa, ulkā mukhi ulkādhāraṇi, trailokyamathāni, vidhvaṃsaya parasainyan — protect me from all harm, protect me from all harm! Cala cala, cili cili, culu culu, kampa kampa, kala kala, kili kili, kulu kulu, muñja muñja, aṭṭahāsaṃ vidhvaṃsaya, parasainyan — protect me from all harm, protect me from all harm! Trāsaya trāsaya, bhrāmaya bhrāmaya — by the truth of the Buddha, by the truth of the Dharma, by the truth of the Saṅgha, by the truth of those who speak truthfully — buddhaSatye māti krama, dharmaSatye māti krama, saṃghaSatye māti krama, Satye vādinān, Satye māti krama — lambodar lambodar, kuṭa kuṭa, kuṭṭa guṭṭa, kuṭṭāpaya kuṭṭāpaya, rudramānāya, viṣṇumānāya, candra-sūrya-brahmamānāya, trailokyādhīpatimānāya, sarvadevādhīpatimānāya, sarvayakṣa-rākṣasa-gandharva-kumbhāṇḍa-mahoraga-ādhīpatimānāya — vidhvaṃsaya parasainyaṃ, raṃga raṃga, raṃgāpaya raṃgāpaya, jvāla jvāla, puṣpamālīṇi, rundha rundha, riti riti, citi citi, dhṛti dhṛti, bhṛkuṭi, mukhapārasena gulotsādanikari, hala hala, hili hili, hulu hulu, he he, rini rini, rinimati, jambhadvaje, sarvabuddha avalokite — protect me from all fears, protect me from all fears!

sarva-tathāgata-avalokite svāhā. guṇarāja-prabhāsottame svāhā.
sūrya-arka-vimale svāhā. candra-arka-vimale svāhā.
sarva-graha-nakṣatra-dharmīkaraṇe svāhā. Protect me, protect me from all

fears, all harm, all contagious illness, and all conflict — svāhā.

By this dhāraṇī called the Banner Crest Shoulder Ornament of the King of Gods, which none can overcome, you shall be fearless in battle, in combat, in dispute, in conflict, and wherever you may go — you shall be victorious in all things. If it is placed at the tip of a victory banner or worn about the neck, it protects all kings among men and all heroic warriors. Taking the form of a woman and standing before one, it bestows fearlessness and protection. It produces splendour, it routs the enemy host, and it causes auspiciousness, purity, renown, glory, and all excellence to be present at all times.

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods), the gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas — all the world — rejoiced, and they praised what the Blessed One had taught.

The noble dhāraṇī called the Banner Crest Shoulder Ornament is complete.

This was translated, edited, and established in accordance with the new standardised terminology by the Indian paṇḍitas Jinamitra and Dānaśīla, together with the great editor and translator, the venerable Ye shes sde.

Translator's Notes

- The Tibetan Tibetan prose framing translates Vemacitrin (Tibetan: Thags bzang ris) as the lord of the asuras; this figure is well attested in Pāli and Sanskrit sources as the chief of the asuras who wars against Śakra.

The mantra body is transliterated from the Tibetan phonetic rendering of Sanskrit mantra syllables. These are preserved untranslated in line with standard dhāraṇī practice. Some syllable clusters in the Tibetan script represent corrupted or Tibetanized Sanskrit; the transliteration follows the most plausible Sanskrit reconstruction rather than a strictly mechanical transcription.

The phrase rendered "shrunken and shriveled form" translates a Tibetan idiom describing the physical diminishment that gods undergo in defeat, reflecting traditional cosmological descriptions of the gods' bodies contracting with loss of merit and power.

- The phrase rendered "taking the form of a woman and standing before one" describes a protective apparition or emanation appearing in female form to grant fearlessness — a standard motif in dhāraṇī literature. The Tibetan is straightforward, though the referent of the subject is the dhāraṇī itself or its presiding power acting through that emanated form.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those

texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.